Liebherr Group – Final speaker notes

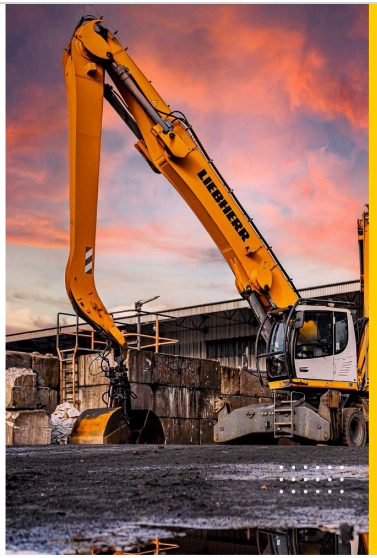
HAT1 Financial Reporting · 12 talk slides · planned speaking time ≈ 9:50 min (1251 words at ≈ 125 words per minute) · backup slides 13–52 for the Q&A

Central question: **How financially strong is Liebherr, and which factors will drive its future performance? For a long-term investor: take a minority stake now – or not yet?**

SPEAKER	SLIDES	TOPICS	TIME	HANDOVER LINE
Adam	1–3	Title; Executive summary; Company and environment	**2:15**	So how does Liebherr compete in this market? Zarah will now show you its competitive advantage, and what it means for the numbers.
Zarah	4–5	Competitive advantage; Financial performance	**2:15**	But can we trust the reported margin? Philipp will now look behind the figures.
Philipp	6–8	Accounting analysis – judgements; Accounting adjustments vs. sensitivities; Financial position and cash flow	**2:50**	Simon will now show you where the cash is tied up, and what all of this means for the investor.
Simon	9–12	Working capital; Investment assessment; Conclusion; Thank you	**2:30**	Closes the talk and opens the Q&A

→ HANDOVER last sentence before the next speaker · **● CLICK** slide 10: one click per condition (3 clicks), then one click to slide 11 · In the HTML version press **P** for the presenter view and **I** for the backup index.

01 **Adam** **Title** 0:35



HAT1 FINANCIAL REPORTING · 2026

Liebherr Group

Financial Reporting and Investment Analysis 2022–2025

CENTRAL QUESTION

How financially strong is Liebherr, and which factors will drive its future performance?

For a long-term investor: take a minority stake now – or not yet?

Benchmark: Caterpillar Inc. and the average of 105 listed US machinery companies

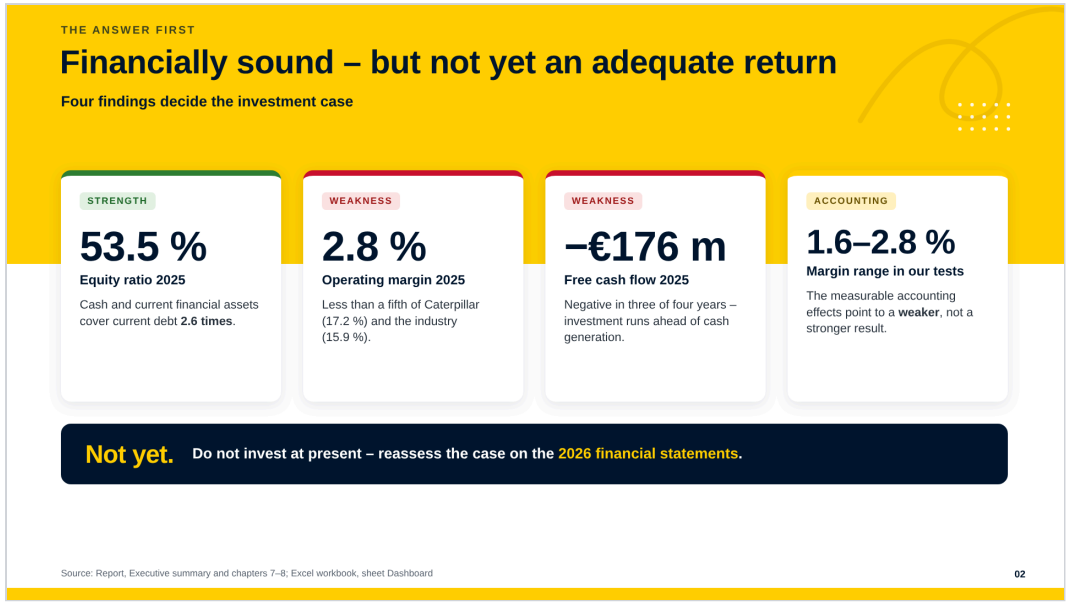
PRESENTED BY

Simon Beermann · Adam Fliegel · Zofia Narkiewicz · Philipp Hoffmann · Zarah Gilmore Islam

Fontys University of Applied Sciences, Venlo · International Finance and Control · Lecturer: Kim Verspeek

Good morning everyone. We are Simon, Adam, Zofia, Philipp and Zarah, and today we present our analysis of the Liebherr Group from 2022 to 2025. My name is Adam, and I will start.

Our report is written for a long-term investor who is considering a minority stake in Liebherr. Our central question is how financially strong Liebherr is, and which factors will drive its future performance. For the investor, the decision is simple. Invest now, or not yet?

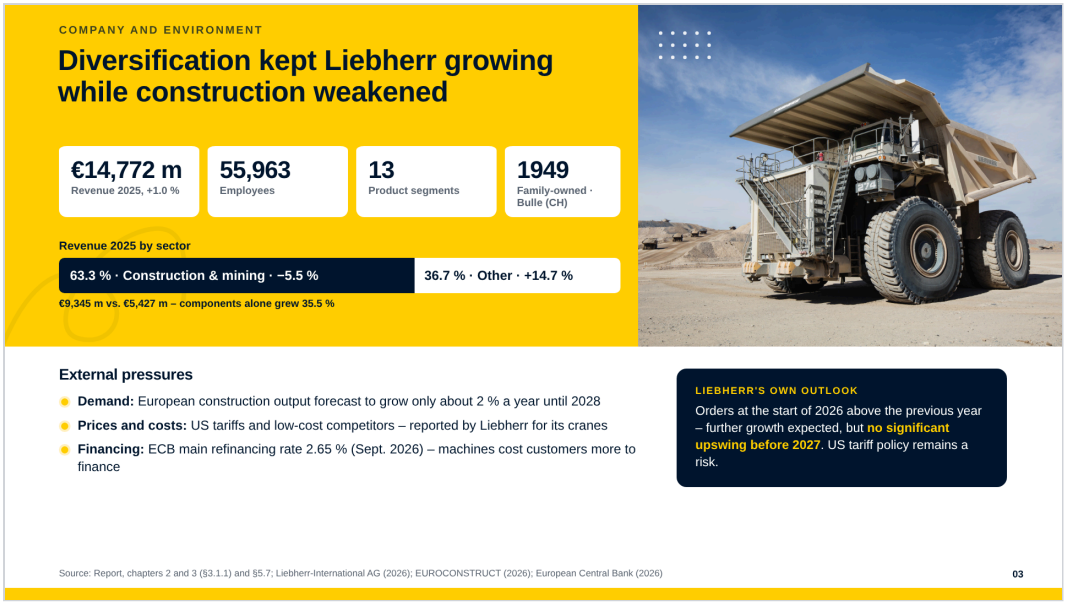


We want to give you the answer first, and our answer is not yet.

Liebherr is financially sound. Equity finances 53.5 per cent of total assets, and cash covers current debt 2.6 times. So the risk of financial distress is low.

But a strong balance sheet is not a good investment by itself. The operating margin was only 2.8 per cent. That is less than a fifth of Caterpillar and of the industry. And free cash flow was negative in three of the four years.

So our advice is to wait, and to reassess the case on the 2026 statements. Let us show you why.



Liebherr is a family-owned, unlisted group with almost 56,000 employees in 13 product segments.

In 2025 construction and mining, which make up almost two thirds of revenue, fell by 5.5 per cent. The other segments grew by 14.7 per cent, and that is why the group still grew a little.

The environment is difficult. Construction in Europe grows only slowly, US tariffs and cheap competitors press on prices, and higher interest rates make machines more expensive. Liebherr itself does not expect a real upswing before 2027.

→ HANDOVER So how does Liebherr compete in this market? Zarah will now show you its competitive advantage, and what it means for the numbers.



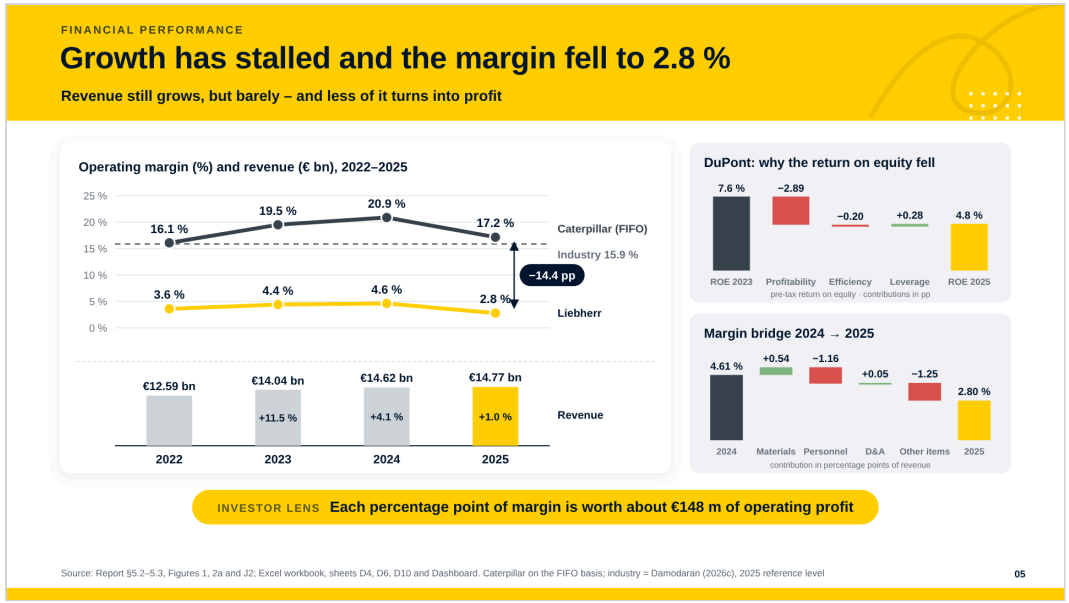
Thank you, Adam.

Three advantages support Liebherr's strategy.

The first one is diversification. Thirteen segments spread the risk, and in 2025 the other segments grew while construction fell. The second one is vertical integration. Liebherr builds key technologies itself and sells through its own companies instead of dealers. The third one is innovation. Research and development rose every year to 708 million euro, a higher share of revenue than at Caterpillar.

But each advantage has a price. Diversification does not raise the margin, vertical integration ties up capital, and research spending kept rising while profit fell.

So the advantage is real, but it sits in the asset base and not yet in the margin. Does it turn into returns? Let's look at the numbers.



The bars at the bottom show revenue. It grew by 11.5 per cent in 2023, but only by 1 per cent in 2025.

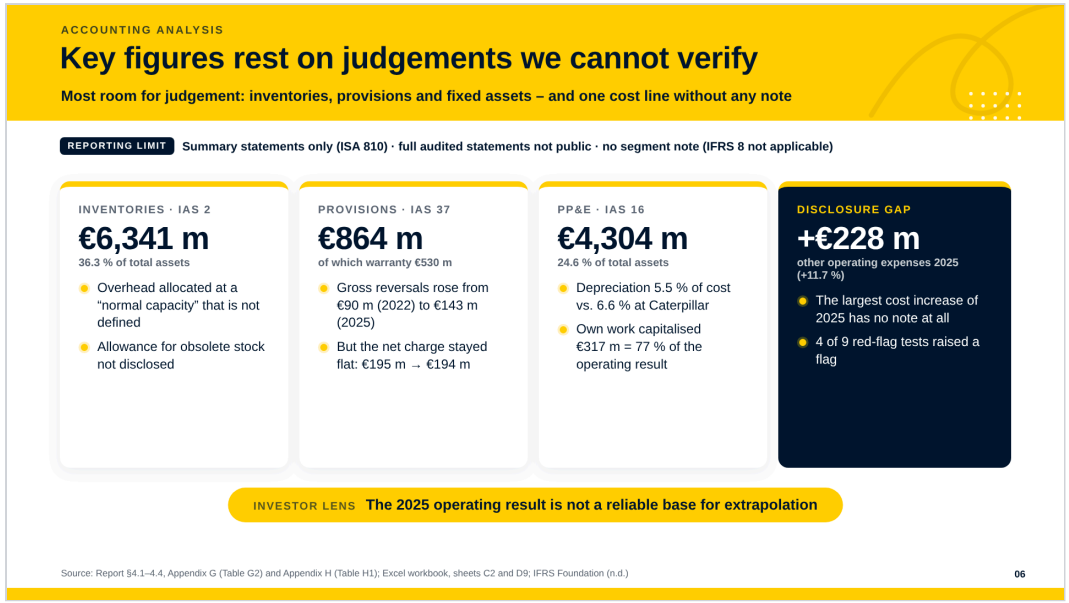
The lines above show the bigger problem. Liebherr's margin, in yellow, was around 4 per cent and fell to 2.8 per cent in 2025. Caterpillar earned 16 to 21 per cent. The gap was there in every single year, so this is not just one bad year.

The bridge on the right explains 2025. Personnel costs grew five times faster than revenue, and other operating items cost another 1.25 points, without any explanation.

The DuPont analysis shows what this means for the owners. The pre-tax return on equity fell from 7.6 to 4.8 per cent, and almost all of it comes from lower profitability, not from debt.

Each point of margin is worth about 148 million euro.

→ HANDOVER But can we trust the reported margin? Philipp will now look behind the figures.

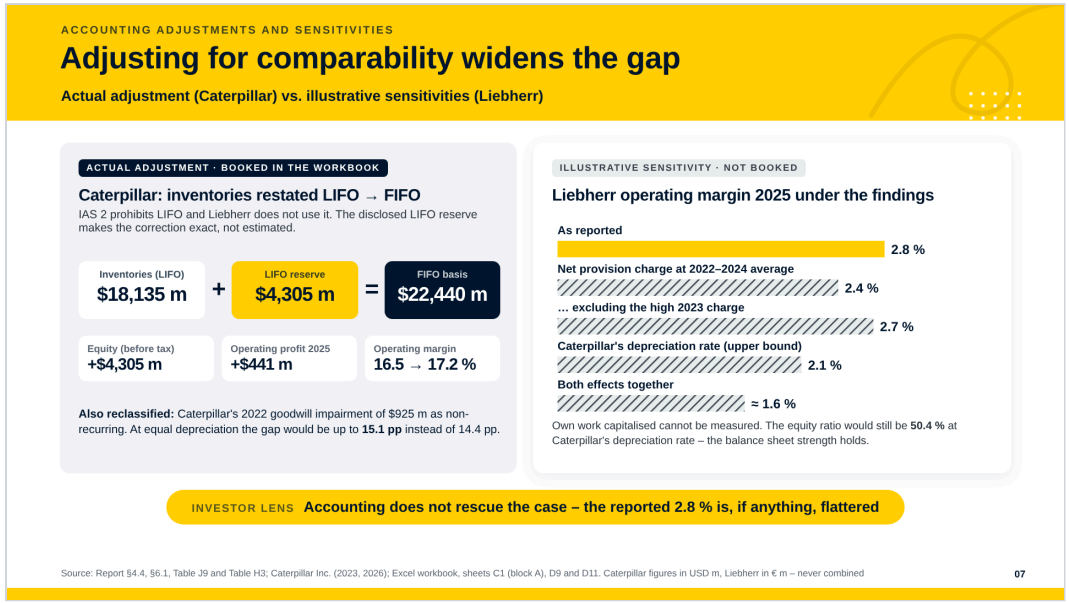


Thank you, Zarah.

Liebherr publishes only summary statements. The full audited statements are not public, and there is no segment note.

Three accounts carry most of the judgement. For inventories, the allowance for old stock is not disclosed. For provisions, the reversals rose to 143 million euro, but the net charge stayed flat. And for fixed assets, Liebherr depreciates more slowly than Caterpillar.

The fourth box matters most. Other operating expenses rose by 228 million euro, and there is no note at all. So the biggest cost increase of 2025 cannot be explained. Four of our nine red-flag tests raised a flag.

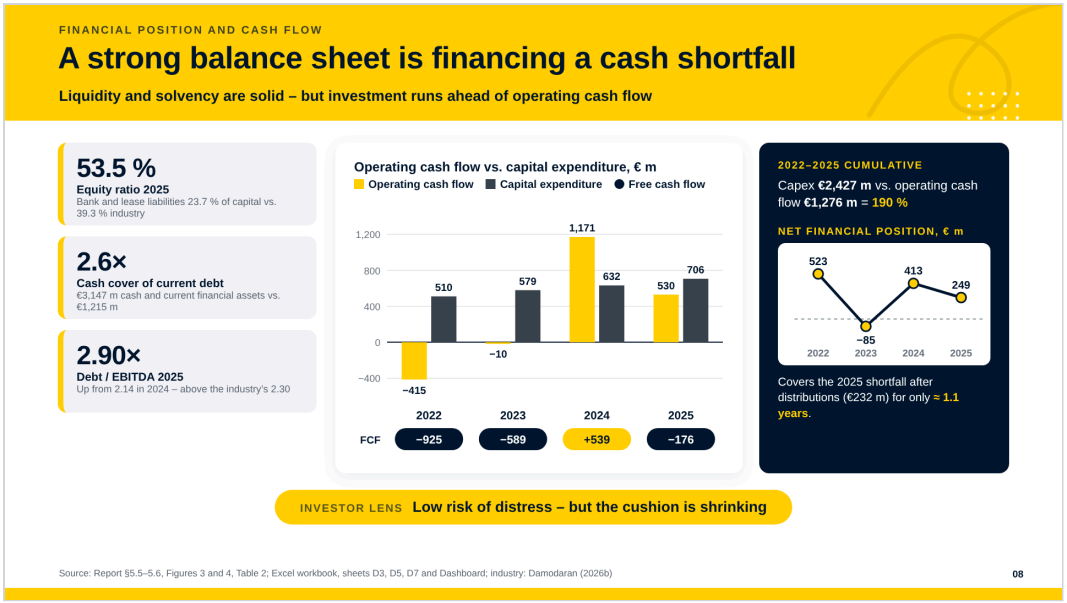


On the left you see an actual adjustment that we made. On the right you see sensitivities that we only measured.

Caterpillar values most of its inventory with LIFO, which IAS 2 does not allow. Because Caterpillar discloses its LIFO reserve, the correction is exact, and it adds 441 million dollars of operating profit. Caterpillar's margin rises from 16.5 to 17.2 per cent, so the gap gets bigger, not smaller.

For Liebherr we only illustrate. With a normal provision charge the margin would be 2.4 per cent, and if we also use Caterpillar's depreciation rate, about 1.6 per cent.

So the accounting does not hide a better company. But the balance sheet strength survives, because the equity ratio stays at around 50 per cent.

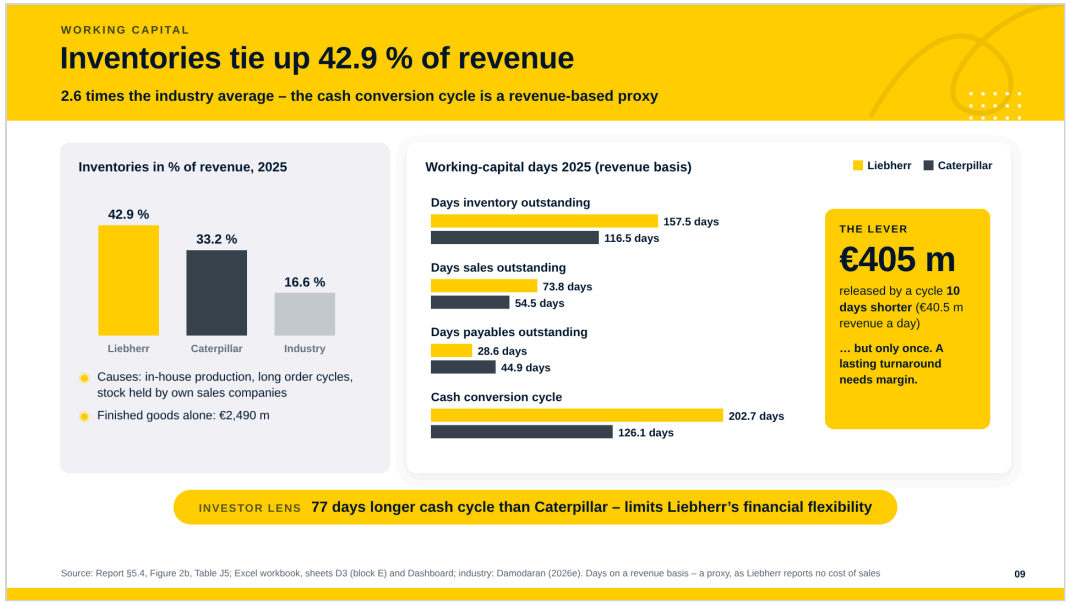


The balance sheet is Liebherr's clearest strength. But now let's look at the cash.

The yellow bars are operating cash flow, and the grey bars are capital expenditure. Over four years Liebherr invested 2.4 billion euro, but generated only 1.3 billion from operations. That is 190 per cent. Free cash flow was negative in three of the four years.

As a result, the cushion is shrinking. The net financial position fell from 523 to 249 million euro. If 2025 happened again, the cushion would last only about one more year. The balance sheet buys time, but it does not replace returns.

→ HANDOVER Simon will now show you where the cash is tied up, and what all of this means for the investor.

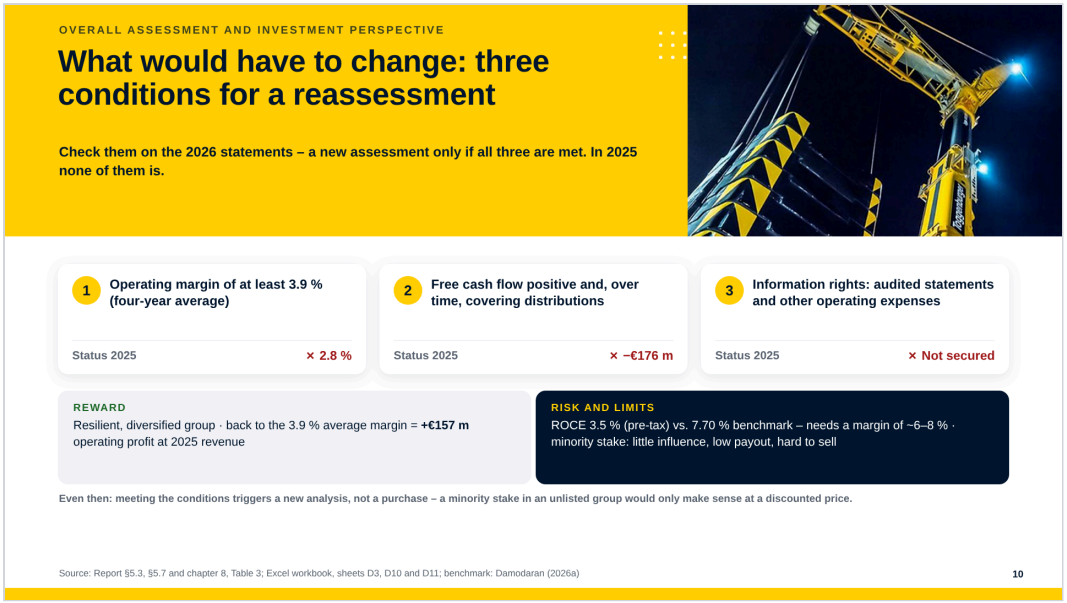


Thank you, Philipp.

So where is the cash tied up? Mostly in inventories. They equal 42.9 per cent of revenue, which is 2.6 times the industry.

Measured in days of revenue, the cash conversion cycle is about 203 days, which is 77 days longer than at Caterpillar. Liebherr holds its stock longer and pays its suppliers faster.

This is the biggest lever that management controls. Ten days less would release about 405 million euro. But this happens only once, so it cannot replace a better margin.



So what would have to change before an investment makes sense? We check three conditions on the 2026 statements.

• CLICK First, the margin should return to at least its four-year average of 3.9 per cent. In 2025 it was 2.8.

• CLICK Second, free cash flow should be positive and cover the distributions. In 2025 it was minus 176 million euro.

• CLICK Third, the investor needs information rights, for example on the 228 million euro of other costs that nobody can explain.

And 3.9 per cent is only a trigger, not a good return. The return on capital employed was 3.5 per cent before tax, against a benchmark of 7.7 per cent.

Also, a minority stake brings little influence, a low payout and shares that are hard to sell. So meeting the conditions starts a new analysis, not a purchase.

• CLICK – NEXT SLIDE



So here is our answer to the central question. Liebherr is financially strong, but operationally challenged.

We have three takeaways. First, the balance sheet is strong, and it survives our accounting tests. Second, returns and cash generation are too weak, and the gap to Caterpillar exists in every year. Third, the accounting analysis makes our verdict sharper.

If the margin stays near 2.8 per cent in 2026 and the net financial position turns negative, the investor should drop the case. In one sentence, see the turn in the figures before committing capital.

Thank you



Thank you.

Simon Beermann · Adam Fliegel · Zofia Narkiewicz · Philipp Hoffmann · Zarah Gilmore Islam · HAT1 Financial Reporting · Fontys Venlo

Images: Liebherr-International AG

On behalf of the whole team, thank you very much for your attention. We are happy to answer your questions.

Q&A Press I for the backup index, every backup slide is one click away. Useful figures for questions. ROCE 2024 was 5.9 % before tax at a 4.6 % margin. The sustainable growth rate is 2.4 %. Personnel expenses were 28.6 % of revenue, against 26.4 % in 2023. Only €56 m of a €272 m profit was distributed in 2025. A deferred tax liability on Caterpillar's LIFO reserve at 21 % would lower its equity ratio only from 24.9 % to 24.2 %.